# Axe



Category: **Hand Tools - Cutting & Shaping** Type: **Short SOP** Priority: **Medium** 7 labs

**Covers these lab items:** Axe; Axe with wooden handle; Garden hatchet

## What it is used for

Use an axe or garden hatchet to cut suitable wood or trim branches with controlled, deliberate strokes.

## How to use

1. Inspect the blade, head, and handle for cracks, looseness, or damage.
2. Choose an axe suitable for the material and task.
3. Clear the work area and ensure others are outside the swing zone.
4. Place the wood securely on a stable chopping surface.
5. Grip the handle firmly and direct each controlled stroke away from your body.
6. Stop if the head loosens or the blade becomes damaged.
7. Clean the blade and fit its protective cover after use.

## ⚠ Safety

- Wear safety glasses, sturdy footwear, and suitable gloves.
- Keep hands and feet clear of the blade path.
- Never use an axe with a loose head or cracked handle.
- Do not chop toward your body or work near other people.

## Care & storage

- Clean and dry the blade after use to prevent rust.
- Store with the blade covered in a secure, dry location.

*Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.*